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Device authentication in a wireless telecommunications network

Abstract

Systems and methods for authenticating User Equipment (UE) are disclosed. The method includes a network obtaining a cross-registration status for the UE based on receiving a registration request from the UE. The network can execute a network registration response according to the cross-registration status that represents a permission given to the UE to register outside of an original network.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/525,626, filed Nov. 12, 2021, entitled “DEVICE AUTHENTICATION IN A WIRELESS TELECOMMUNICATIONS NETWORK,” which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/927,814 (now issued as U.S. Pat. No. 11,206,535), filed Jul. 13, 2020, entitled “DEVICE AUTHENTICATION IN A WIRELESS TELECOMMUNICATIONS NETWORK,” which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety.

BACKGROUND

(1) Rapid growth in computing technology is creating greater demand for data communication. For example, the number of communicating devices are rapidly increasing due to technological advances in mobile computing, Internet of Things (IoT), wearable devices, and other such electronic devices. Such technological advances are also driving development of new software/mobile applications that introduce new ways to share, utilize, and consume communicated data. Unfortunately, the number of nefarious or unauthorized attempts to capitalize on the technological advancements is also increasing rapidly.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 illustrates a communication network in which some implementations of the present technology can be utilized.
- (2) FIG. 2 illustrates example operating details in accordance with one or more implementations of the present technology.
- (3) FIG. 3 is a flow diagram illustrating an example method for reporting location information in accordance with one or more implementations of the present technology.
- (4) FIG. 4 is a diagrammatic representation of a machine in the example form of a computer system

within which a set of instructions, for causing the machine to perform any one or more of the methodologies discussed herein, can be executed.

(5) In the drawings, some components and/or operations can be separated into different blocks or combined into a single block for discussion of some of the implementations of the present technology. Moreover, while the technology is amenable to various modifications and alternative forms, specific implementations have been shown by way of example in the drawings and are described in detail below. The intention, however, is not to limit the technology to the particular implementations described. On the contrary, the technology is intended to cover all modifications, equivalents, and alternatives falling within the scope of the technology as defined by the appended claims.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(6) A mobile communication network (e.g., a cellular communication network) can facilitate data transfers between end-user devices, such as between a mobile personal device (e.g., a User Equipment (UE)) and a service provider device (e.g., a server). The mobile communication network (the “network”) can transfer data to and from the end-user devices according to one or more channel access methods/mechanisms. For example, a telecommunication service provider (e.g., a carrier) may operate a Global System for Mobile Communications (GSM) network and/or a Code-Division Multiple Access (CDMA) type network.

(7) The different types of networks can implement different registration mechanisms or protocols. For example, the UEs may be required to use device-based identifiers to register with and utilize the CDMA type networks. In other words, a hardware device (e.g., the UE, such as a smart phone) may be contractually subscribed to a CDMA network. Also, a UE configured to access the GSM type network may be configured to accept a transportable access module (e.g., a Subscriber Identity Module (SIM) card). The UE may register with and utilize the GSM type network based on a unique identifier associated with the access module. Accordingly, the subscription may be contractually associated with the access module while being agnostic as to the hardware device facilitated by the access module. In other words, the user may access the GSM network using different devices (i.e., at different times) as long as the user inserts the authorized SIM card into the different devices.

(8) Despite the different registration mechanisms, mobile devices are often configured with the capacity to operate on multiple different types of networks. In some aspects, the UE manufacturers configure the devices with the increased capacity to increase the number of potential customers while maintaining uniform design. Also, some higher-bandwidth communication protocols (e.g., Long-Term Evolution (LTE) or Fifth Generation (5G) Radio standards) are requiring the use of access modules. Accordingly, when a network provider deploys the higher-bandwidth network in addition to an existing CDMA network, a subscriber UE is required to use the access module to utilize the new network. In some instances, a network provider can simultaneously operate different types of networks (e.g., both a GSM network and a CDMA network), such as due to mergers or purchases.

(9) The enhanced operability can provide increased flexibilities for a network provider and the user. For example, a user may use the same device to subscribe to different network providers once a previous contractual obligation has been met. In other words, once a mobile device is unlocked, a user may use the unlocked device to subscribe to and utilize a network without being limited by the channel access technology of the network. Also, for example, a carrier that provides multiple types of networks may provide and implement different access plans by leveraging the different registration mechanisms.

(10) Unfortunately, the enhanced operability can also introduce new ways to nefariously access network services. As an illustrative example, a carrier can provide both a CDMA network and a GSM network. The carrier can provide different subscription plans (based on, e.g., available maximum bandwidths, prepaid device plans, refurbished device plans, etc.) for the CDMA network

and/or the GSM network. For such networks, a nefarious usage scenario may include a prepaid or a liquidated (e.g., refurbished) CDMA device (i.e., subscribed to a limited/lower-level access to the CDMA network) being used to access a premium service (e.g., LTE or 5G network associated with the GSM network) via a corresponding SIM card. In other words, a nefarious user may attempt to bypass contractual obligations/limitations of the CDMA device using a SIM card associated with the GSM network.

(11) Implementations of the present technology enables a network to authenticate and manage registration of devices across networks having different channel access methods and different registration mechanisms. For example, the network can manage registration of CDMA devices within a GSM environment (or vice versa). The network can be an integrated environment (e.g., an integrated network that includes both CDMA and GSM sub-networks) that allows for CDMA devices to operate in GSM network. In managing device registrations, the network can query an eligibility database for contractual status of the registering device (e.g., CDMA-based device). The network can register the requesting device and provide network access thereto when the database indicates eligibility status (e.g., having met requirements for unlocking the device). Otherwise, the network can deny registration and prevent the requesting device to access/utilize the network (e.g., a core network **106** therein). Accordingly, the network can block nefarious or unauthorized attempts to gain access thereto by using unlocked secondary registration mechanism (e.g., an access module, such as a SIM card) to override or hide locked status associated with a primary registration mechanism (e.g., CDMA-based contractual obligation).

(12) Along with denying the registration request, the network can temporarily blacklist the requesting device (i.e., instead of permanently blacklisting the device). The temporary status can expire relatively quickly (e.g., within minutes) to enable the device to re-register using a proper SIM. In other words, the network may enable the user to properly unlock the same device and register for the network based on the temporary/expiring blacklist status.

(13) In the following description, for the purposes of explanation, numerous specific details are set forth in order to provide a thorough understanding of implementations of the present technology. It will be apparent, however, to one skilled in the art that implementations of the present technology can be practiced without some of these specific details.

(14) The techniques introduced here can be implemented as special-purpose hardware (for example, circuitry), as programmable circuitry appropriately programmed with software and/or firmware, or as a combination of special-purpose and programmable circuitry. Hence, implementations can include a machine-readable medium having stored thereon instructions which can be used to program a computer (or other electronic devices) to perform a process. The machine-readable medium can include, but is not limited to, floppy diskettes, optical discs, compact disc read-only memories (CD-ROMs), magneto-optical disks, ROMs, random access memories (RAMs), erasable programmable read-only memories (EPROMs), electrically erasable programmable read-only memories (EEPROMs), magnetic or optical cards, flash memory, or other types of media/machine-readable medium suitable for storing electronic instructions.

(15) The phrases “in some implementations,” “according to some implementations,” “in the implementations shown,” “in other implementations,” and the like generally mean the particular feature, structure, or characteristic following the phrase is included in at least one implementation of the present technology and can be included in more than one implementation. In addition, such phrases do not necessarily refer to the same implementations or different implementations.

(16) Suitable Environment

(17) FIG. **1** illustrates a first communication first network **100** (also referred to herein as the first network **100**) in accordance with various implementations or embodiments. The first network **100** can communicatively couple devices including a mobile device **102** (e.g., a User Equipment (UE)). Some examples of the mobile device **102** can include a mobile phone (e.g., a smart phone), a laptop, a transceiver in a vehicle, a wearable device (e.g., a smart watch, augmented-reality (AR)

glasses, virtual-reality (VR) glasses, etc.), an IoT device, and the like.

(18) The first network **100** may include access nodes configured to serve as hubs that function as gateways for the first network **100**. Some examples of the access node can include a Radio Access Network (RAN) Node (e.g., an Evolved-Universal Terrestrial Radio Access Network (E-UTRAN) Node B (eNode B or eNB), a Radio Network Controller (RNCs) in an E-UTRAN, and/or a next generation Node B (gNB)). The access node may also include a base station, a Wireless Fidelity (WiFi) router, a modem, and/or other network gateway devices. The access nodes can be configured to communicate with the mobile device **102** according to one or more communication protocols or standards. Some examples of the communication protocols or standards can include: Global System for Mobile Communications (GSM), Internet Protocol (IP) Multimedia Subsystem (IMS), Time Division Multiple Access (TDMA), Universal Mobile Telecommunications System (UMTS), Evolution-Data Optimized (EVDO), Long Term Evolution (LTE), Generic Access Network (GAN), Unlicensed Mobile Access (UMA), Code Division Multiple Access (CDMA) protocols (e.g., IS-95, IS-2000, and IS-856 protocols), Advanced LTE or LTE+, Orthogonal Frequency Division Multiple Access (OFDM), General Packet Radio Service (GPRS), Enhanced Data GSM Environment (EDGE), Advanced Mobile Phone System (AMPS), WiMAX protocols (e.g., IEEE 802.16e-2005 and IEEE 802.16m protocols), any of the various IEEE 802.11 standards, High Speed Packet Access (HSPA), (including High Speed Downlink Packet Access (HSDPA) and High Speed Uplink Packet Access (HSUPA)), Ultra Mobile Broadband (UMB), 5G NR (New Radio), and/or other communication technologies. As an illustrative example, the first network **100** can operate according to a first access mechanism **104** (e.g., a channel access method/mechanism and/or a corresponding network structure or protocol).

(19) In general, the first network **100** can include multiple cells, with each cell including one or more BSs (macro cell), 5G transceivers (including small cell devices), or a combination of both macro and small cells (HetNets), though many other cell types are possible including cells having one or more femtocells, picocells, IEEE 802.11 access points (WiFi APs), and the like. Depending on the configuration and size, the first network **100** can represent and serve various regional areas, for example, one or more rooms, one or more blocks, a city, a state, an entire nation, the whole world, etc.

(20) The first network **100** can provide a wireless communicative connection between the access node and the mobile device **102** according to one or more wireless communication standards/protocols as described above. The first network **100** can include network nodes communicatively coupled to the access nodes and configured to process and/or route information to/from the mobile device **102** to counterpart communication endpoints (e.g., service providers, content/service servers, and/or other end-user devices). The access nodes can be communicatively coupled (for example, using a backhaul connection) to backhaul equipment, for example, an operation support subsystem (OSS) server, a radio network controller (RNC), etc. Some examples of the network nodes can include a mobility management entity (MME), a serving gateway (SGW), and/or a package data network (PDN) gateway (PGW). Additionally or alternatively, the network nodes can include Network Functions (NFs).

(21) A grouping of the network nodes can form a core network **106** that is configured to function as a backbone portion of the first network **100**. For example, the core network **106** can include components (e.g., a set of the network nodes) configured to implement wireless communications, such as cellular communication networks and/or wireless fidelity networks. The core network **106** can be connected to different parts of the first network **100**, such as the Internet and/or telephone networks. Accordingly, the core network **106** can establish/facilitate communication sessions for exchanging data between communication endpoints (e.g., end-user devices and/or service provider servers). In some implementations, the core network **106** can include an IP Multimedia Core network Subsystem (IMS).

(22) The first network **100** may be operated by a service/network provider. End users may sign up

as subscribers of the provider and one or more networks thereof. A single provider may operate one or more networks. In some instances, the provider may operate multiple networks corresponding to multiple protocols or access technologies. For example, a single provider may operate a 3G network, a 4G network, a 5G network, a telephone network, an IP-based network, and/or other such networks. Accordingly, a subscribing UE may be able to access one or more of the operating networks, simultaneously and/or separately.

(23) For the example illustrated in FIG. 1, the first network **100** can be coupled to a second network **108** that operates according to a second access mechanism **110** (e.g., a channel access method/mechanism and/or a corresponding network structure or protocol). The second access mechanism **110** can be different from the first access mechanism **104**. For example, the first access mechanism **104** can correspond to the GSM standard or a related network structure, and the second access mechanism **110** can correspond to the CDMA standard or a related network structure. In some implementations, one service provider (e.g., one carrier) can implement or operate both the first network **100** and the second network **108**. Alternatively, the first network **100** and the second network **108** can correspond to different carriers.

(24) In some implementations, the subscribed user and/or the user's device (e.g., the mobile device **102**) may be contractually limited in the ability to utilize the networks provided by the carrier. Accordingly, the subscribed user may be limited to utilize a subset of access mechanisms and/or networks instead of the full set supported by the carrier.

(25) Authentication methods for the different networks can correspond to the implemented access mechanism. For example, the second access mechanism **110** (e.g., CDMA-based protocol) can tie the subscription directly to devices (e.g., the mobile device). Accordingly, authentication for the second network **108** can require a device-based identifier **112** (e.g., an International Mobile Equipment Identity (IMEI)) that is unique to the hardware of the mobile device **102** and not transferrable to different devices, even when the devices are commonly owned. In comparison, the first access mechanism **104** (e.g., GSM-based protocol) can associate the subscription to an access module **114** (e.g., a Subscriber Identity Module (SIM)) that corresponds to a unique module-based identifier **116** (e.g., an International Mobile Subscriber Identity (IMSI)). Accordingly, authentication for the first network **100** can require the module-based identifier **116**. As such, a user may access the first network **100** using different devices (i.e., at different times) by transferring the module-based identifier **116** into the accessing device.

(26) In registering to access a network, the mobile device **102** can interact with a core access node **122** (e.g., an instance of a network node/function, such as a Proxy-Call Session Control Function (P-CSCF) or a Session Border Controller (SBC)). The core access node **122** can include hardware (e.g., circuitry), software, and/or firmware configured to interact with the mobile device **102** through the wireless connection and function as a gateway to the core network **106**. Accordingly, the core access node **122** can be configured to facilitate registration of the mobile device **102** for the core network **106**, such as for providing/allowing access to the core network **106**. For example, the core access node **122** can function as a Session Initiation Protocol (SIP) proxy. The core access node **122** can receive, process, and/or forward to other network nodes a registration request from the mobile device **102**. The core access node **122** can further send a registration response to the mobile device **102**.

(27) As an illustrative example, the mobile device **102** can send the registration request to the core access node **122** via the wireless connection. The mobile device **102** can be configured to include module-based identifier **116** and/or the device-based identifier **112** in the registration request. Upon receiving the registration request, the core network **106** (at, e.g., the core access node **122** and/or other nodes, such as a Serving-CSCF, and/or other nodes/functions) can analyze the one or more identifiers. The core network **106** can compare the one or more identifiers to information associated with access, subscription, contractual conditions, etc.

(28) In some implementations, one or more network nodes can communicate with a subscription

database **124** (e.g., a Home Subscriber Server (HSS) and/or a financial eligibility service server) to authorize or verify the identification of the requesting device. In one or more implementations, the subscription database **124** can be separate from the HSS and/or track contractual lock or unlock status. The subscription database **124** can be a network node that maintains a subscription profile **126** representative of network subscribers and/or information related thereto. For example, the subscription profile **126** can be used to track a device subscription data **128**, a module subscription data **130**, and/or an unlocked status **134** corresponding to one or more contractual terms **132** associated with a subscriber. The device subscription data **128** can specify the device-based identifiers associated with subscriber accounts, and the module subscription data **130** can specify the module-based identifier **116** associated with a subscriber account. In other words, the device subscription data **128** can represent the device-based identifier **112** authorized to access the core network **106**, and the module subscription data **130** can represent the module-based identifiers authorized to access the core network **106**. The unlocked status **134** can represent whether the subscriber has met the contractual terms **132** (e.g., a contractual duration and/or payment of a required sum).

(29) Operating Details

(30) FIG. 2 illustrates example operating details in accordance with one or more implementations of the present technology. FIG. 2 represents communications between a locked device **202** and the first network **100**. The locked device **202** can be an instance of the mobile device **102** that is subject to contractual network access limitations. For example, the locked device **202** can be a CDMA-based device subject to contractually limited to accessing only the second network **108**. As described above, the second network **108** can be within an integrated environment (e.g., operated by a common carrier) that also includes the first network **100**.

(31) Unfortunately, in providing enhanced accessibility across different networks that correspond to different access mechanisms, the network provider introduces new ways for users to gain unauthorized access to one or more of the networks. As an illustrative example, the carrier can provide different subscription plans (based on, e.g., available maximum bandwidths, prepaid device plans, refurbished device plans, etc.) for the first network **100** and/or the second network **108**. A user nefariously or mistakenly may use an authorized identifier for one network to override access limitations associated with another network. For example, the locked device **202** can be subscribed to a limited/lower-level access to the second network **108**. The locked device **202** may be used to attempt unauthorized access to the first network **100** (e.g., the GSM network and/or a premium network supported by the GSM network) by coupling the locked device **202** with a mismatching module **204** to access the first network **100**. The locked device **202** can be a lower priced device, such as a prepaid device or a liquidated/refurbished device, having contractual limitations to access only the CDMA network or a portion thereof. The mismatching module **204** can include the access module **114** contractually independent of the locked device **202** and subscribed to access GSM network. In other words, a user may, nefariously or otherwise, attempt to bypass the contractual obligations/limitations of the locked device **202** using a SIM card associated with the GSM network.

(32) As described in detail below, implementations of the present technology enable the carrier to authenticate and manage registration of devices across one or more of the supported networks. For example, the carrier can manage registration of CDMA devices within a GSM environment (or vice versa). In managing device registrations, the first network **100** can query the subscription database **124** (e.g., a first database **212** corresponding to the first network **100** and/or a second database **214** corresponding to the second network **108**) for access-related status of the mobile device **102** (e.g., CDMA-based device). The first network **100** can register the mobile device **102** and provide network access thereto when the database indicates eligibility status (e.g., having met requirements for unlocking the device). Otherwise, the first network **100** can deny registration and prevent the requesting device to access/utilize thereto (e.g., a core network **106** therein).

(33) As an illustrative example, the locked device **202** can send a registration request **222** to the first network **100** via a base station and a corresponding wireless connection. The registration request **222** can be sent in an attempt to gain access to the first network **100** or the core network **106** therein. The registration request **222** can be sent according to a Session Initiation Protocol (SIP). The locked device **202** can send the device-based identifier **112** and/or the module-based identifier **116** along with or within the registration request **222**. The first network **100** can receive and begin processing the registration request **222** via the core access node **122** (e.g., P-CSCF).

(34) The process the registration request **222**, the first network **100** (via, e.g., the core access node **122** and/or another network node) can send a subscription status query **224** to one or more subscription databases **124**. For example, the first network **100** can send the subscription status query **224** to the first database **212** (e.g., the HSS associated with the first network **100**) and/or the second database **214** (e.g., the financial eligibility service server associated with the second network **108**). When across different networks, such as when sent from the first network **100** to the second network **108**, the subscription status query **224** can correspond to a cross-registration query for determining whether the requesting device is authorized to register with another network (e.g., the querying network). For example, the cross-registration query can inquire with the second network **108** whether the locked device **202** has met its contractual obligations (e.g., whether it is unlocked) to be able to register with the first network **100**. The subscription status query **224** can include the device-based identifier **112** and/or the module-based identifier **116**.

(35) In response to receiving the subscription status query **224**, the one or more subscription databases **124** can search the subscription profiles **126** thereof for the device-based identifier **112** and/or the module-based identifier **116**. For example, the first database **212** can compare the device-based identifier **112** to the device subscription data **128** and/or compare the module-based identifier **116** to the module subscription data **130**. The first network **100** can authorize the requesting device to access the core network **106** when the device-based identifier is listed in the device subscription data **128** and/or when the module-based identifier **116** is listed in the module subscription data **130**. The first network **100** can deny registration of requesting device when the module-based identifier **116** is absent within the module subscription data **130**. The first network **100** can communicate with the second network **108** when the comparisons generate inconsistent results.

(36) For the example illustrated in FIG. 2, the module-based identifier **116** is listed in the module subscription data **130** since the mismatching module **204** is associated with the first network **100**. However, the device-based identifier **112** of the locked device **202** is absent within the device subscription data **128** for the first network **100**. Accordingly, the first network **100** can send the cross-registration query (e.g., a subsequent instance of the subscription status query **224**) to the second network **108**. Like the first database **212**, the second database **214** of the second network **108** can compare the device-based identifier **112** to the device subscription data **128** and/or compare the module-based identifier **116** to the module subscription data **130** in response to receiving the cross-registration query. As described above, the device-based identifier **112** may be listed in the device subscription data **128** of the second network **108**. However, the unlocked status **134** of the locked device **202** represents that the device has not met the contractual term **132**. The second network **108** can generate a subscription status response **226** (e.g., a cross-registration status) in response the cross-registration query. The subscription status response **226** can include the unlocked status **134**. For the locked device **202**, the unlocked status **134** in the subscription status response **226** can indicate a locked status according to the conditions/context described above.

(37) The first network **100** can receive the subscription status response **226** from the second network **108**. When the subscription status response **226** indicates that the requesting device is an unlocked device (e.g., the device user has satisfied the contractual terms **132**), the first network **100** can facilitate the device to access the first network **100**. Otherwise, when the subscription status

response **226** indicates that the requesting device is a locked device (e.g., the device user has not satisfied the contractual terms **132**), the first network **100** can determine that the requesting device as the locked device **202**. Accordingly, the first network **100** can block the locked device **202** from accessing the first network **100**.

(38) Additionally or alternatively, the first network **100** can update a network blacklist **228** to include the device-based identifier **112** and/or the module-based identifier **116** along with denying network access. In some implementation, the first network **100** can set/initiate a blackout timer **230** for the added identifier(s). The blackout timer **230** can include a circuit or a software function that measures a duration (e.g., a counter) for blacklisting the added addresses. In other words, the first network **100** can temporarily blacklist the locked device **202** using the blackout timer **230**. The first network **100** can remove the added identifier(s) from the network blacklist **228** when the blackout timer **230** indicates that a predetermined duration has passed.

(39) In some implementations, the first network **100** can further send a registration error message **232**. The registration error message **232** can include a message for the user of the locked device **202** that indicates the locked status of the device and/or human-readable content indicating the basis for denying registration. For example, the registration error message **232** can include a Short Message Service (SMS) message, an email, a popup, or other audio-visual message.

(40) The first network **100** can use the blackout timer **230** and/or the registration error message **232** to avoid permanently blacklisting the device in error. The registration request **222** may have been sent in error (e.g., without finishing a subscriber account initiation or a subscription update or an incorrect SIM accidentally inserted) and/or the locked status may have been determined due to an internal error. Accordingly, the blackout timer **230** allows the user and/or the locked device **202** to register with the first network **100** at a later time, such as after addressing any errors or contractual obligations of the user. Moreover, the registration error message **232** can notify the user of the denial and/or the cause so that the user may know to address any errors or contractual obligations (e.g. insert the proper SIM if an incorrect one was inadvertently inserted).

(41) Control Flow

(42) FIG. 3 is a flow diagram illustrating an example method **300** for authenticating the mobile device **102** in accordance with one or more implementations of the present technology. The method **300** can be for operating the first network **100** to authenticate subscription status of devices requesting registration to a network within an integrated or a multi-network environment. The method **300** may be implemented using one or more network nodes of the first network **100** and/or the second network **108**.

(43) At block **302**, the first network **100** can receive a registration request (e.g., the registration request **222**). The registration request may be a SIP message from the mobile device **102** (e.g., the UE). The first network **100** can receive the registration request **222** from the UE **102** at the core access node **122**, such as the P-CSCF and/or the I-CSCF. The registration request **222** may be for establishing a base-level connection, such as for facilitating voice communication functions of the mobile device **102**.

(44) At block **304**, the first network **100** can identify one or more device identifiers based on the registration request. For example, the first network **100** can use a network node (e.g., the core access node **122**) to identify the device-based identifier **112** and/or the module-based identifier **116** based on the registration request **222**. The first network **100** can identify the one or more device identifiers according to a predetermined sequence and/or a predetermined format associated with the registration request **222**.

(45) At decision block **306**, the first network **100** can determine whether the one or more device identifiers are included in the network blacklist **228**. For example, the first network **100** can use one or more network nodes (e.g., the core access node **122** and/or the HSS) to compare the device-based identifier **112** and/or the module-based identifier **116** to the network blacklist **228**. When the device-based identifier **112** and/or the module-based identifier **116** matches an entry in the network

blacklist **228** (i.e., the requesting device is blacklisted), the first network **100** can deny network access to the mobile device **102** as illustrated at block **308**. In other words, the first network **100** can prevent the mobile device **102** from accessing the core network **106** within the first network **100** in response to the received request.

(46) When the device-based identifier **112** and/or the module-based identifier **116** are not found within the network blacklist **228** (i.e., the requesting device is not blacklisted), the first network **100** can access network-internal subscription data as illustrated at block **310**. For example, the first network **100** can access the subscription profile **126** managed by the subscription database **124** (e.g., the HSS) associated with the first network **100**. In some implementations, the first network **100** can access the subscription profile **126** based on communicating network-internal instances of the subscription status query **224** and the subscription status response **226**. For example, the core access node **122** and the internal subscription database **124** can exchange information to determine whether the requesting mobile device **102** corresponds to a subscriber for the first network **100**. The first network **100** can determine the subscriptions status of the requesting mobile device **102** based on comparing (1) the module-based identifier **116** to the module subscription data **130** and/or (2) the device-based identifier **112** to the device subscription data **128**.

(47) In some implementations, the first network **100** (e.g., the GSM network) can require verification of both the module-based identifier **116** and the device-based identifier **112** for allowing the requesting device to access the core network **106**. At decision block **312**, the first network **100** can determine whether the access module **114** corresponds to a subscriber of the first network **100**. The first network **100** can compare the module-based identifier **116** to the module subscription data **130**. When the module-based identifier **116** is absent in the module subscription data **130**, the first network **100** can determine that the access module **114** of the requesting mobile device **102** is not a subscriber module. Accordingly, the first network **100** can execute a corresponding network registration response, such as by adding the module-based identifier **116** to a blacklist (e.g., the network blacklist **228**) (block **324**) and/or denying network access to the requesting mobile device (block **308**). Details regarding the blacklisting are described below.

(48) When the module-based identifier **116** is included in the module subscription data **130**, the first network **100** can determine that the access module **114** of the requesting mobile device **102** is a subscriber module. Accordingly, the first network **100** can determine whether the mobile device **102** corresponds to a subscriber of the first network **100** as illustrated at decision block **314**. The first network **100** can compare the device-based identifier **112** to the device subscription data **128** for the first network **100**. When the device-based identifier **112** is included in the device subscription data **128**, the first network **100** can conclude that the requesting mobile device **102** corresponds to an authorized subscriber of the first network **100**. Accordingly, at block **316**, the first network **100** can facilitate network access for the mobile device **102**. In other words, the first network **100** can allow the mobile device **102** to access the core network **106**.

(49) When the device-based identifier **112** is absent in the device subscription data **128**, the first network **100** can determine that the registration request may be from the mobile device **102** initially configured to operate on the second network **108** (e.g., a network implementing a different channel access mechanism). Accordingly, at block **318**, the first network **100** can determine a cross-registration status by communicating with the second network **108**. The first network **100** can send a cross-registration query (e.g., an instance of the subscription status query **224** sent across different networks) to the second network **108** to identify unlocked devices authorized to connect to a network (e.g., the first network **100**) outside of an initially-contracted network (e.g., the second network **108**). The cross-registration query can include the module-based identifier **116** and/or the device-based identifier **112**.

(50) The second network **108** can process the cross-registration query using a cross-registration database (e.g., an instance of the subscription database **124** for the second network **108**). The second network **108** can compare the module-based identifier **116** and/or compare the device-based

identifier **112** to subscriber data. The second network **108** can send a cross-registration status (e.g., an instance of the subscription status response **226** communicated across different networks) that represents the comparison results to the first network **100**.

(51) As an illustrative example, the CDMA network can receive the cross-registration query when the GSM network is unable to authenticate the SIM of the requesting device. The CDMA network can compare the device-based identifier **112** to the network subscriber list (e.g., the device subscription data **128** of the CDMA network). When the device-based identifier **112** corresponds to a subscriber, the CDMA network can determine the unlocked status **134**, such as by accessing a predetermined data storage location and/or by analyzing authorization data like fulfillment status of the contractual terms **132** (e.g., subscribed duration, subscription status, payment status, or other authorized unlock status). The CDMA network can send the cross-registration status that indicates whether the mobile device **102** is limited to accessing only the second network (e.g., a locked status) or is given permission to register outside of the second network **108** (e.g., an unlocked status). The second network **108** can be configured to return the unlocked status when the mobile device **102** is not included in the subscriber data for the second network **108**. Accordingly, the first network **100** can identify the mobile device **102** as a new device being used by a subscriber. In some implementations, the first network **100** and/or the second network **108** can include components that validate an authentication eligibility. Accordingly, the components can be configured to intercept authentication requests from the mobile device **102**, such as when the mobile device **102** not recognized by the corresponding network. While the mobile device **102** may be able to register on the network, the IMEI can be validated to determine movement eligibility and registration permitted or disallowed based on the criteria.

(52) The first network **100** can execute a network registration response according to the cross-registration status of the mobile device **102**. The first network **100** can execute the network registration response to control access of the network by the mobile device **102**. At decision block **320**, the first network **100** can receive the cross-registration status from the second network **108** and determine whether the requesting mobile device **102** is locked. When the cross-registration status indicates that the requesting mobile device **102** not locked, the first network **100** can facilitate network access for the mobile device **102** (block **316**). For example, the first network **100** can enable a CDMA-configured device to operate in a GSM environment when the cross-registration status indicates the mobile device **102** as an unlocked device.

(53) Otherwise, when the cross-registration status indicates that the requesting mobile device **102** is locked, the first network **100** can identify the requesting mobile device **102** as the locked device **202**. The first network **100** can further determine from the locked status an absence of permission for the locked device **202** to register outside of the second network **108**.

(54) Accordingly, the first network **100** can temporarily blacklist the locked device **202**. To implement the temporary status, the first network **100** can associate the locked device **202** to the blackout timer **230** (via, e.g., setting a pointer from the blacklist entry of the device-based identifier to a counter) as illustrated at block **322**. Also as illustrated at block **322**, the first network **100** can initiate the blackout timer **230**.

(55) At block **324**, the first network **100** can add one or more identifiers of the requesting mobile device **102** to the network blacklist **228**. For example, the first network **100** can add the device-based identifier **112** and/or the module-based identifier **116** to the network blacklist **228**. Along with blacklisting the device, the first network **100** can deny network access for the non-verified device (block **308**). Subsequent registration request from the blacklisted device can be handled as described above for blocks **306** and **308**.

(56) When the requesting device is determined as the locked device **202**, the first network **100** can temporarily add the corresponding device-based identifier **112** and/or module-based identifier **116** to the network blacklist **228** for preventing the UE from accessing the network for a limited predetermined duration following reception of the registration request **222**. In some

implementations, the first network **100** can also send a user message (e.g., the registration error message **232**) as illustrated at block **326**. Accordingly, the first network **100** can enable the user to remedy any inadvertent errors or contractual conditions for reregistering the mobile device **102** (i.e., without permanently blacklisting the device).

(57) For temporarily blacklisting a device, the blackout timer **230** can start counting up to or down from a predetermined duration for blacklisting the locked device **202**. At block **328**, the first network **100** can determine (via, e.g., an interrupt routine) whether the predetermined duration has lapsed. The first network **100** can continue to monitor the blackout timer **230** until the predetermined duration lapses. If the locked device **202** attempts to re-register during the predetermined duration, the first network **100** can deny network access as described above for blocks **306** and **308**. After the predetermined duration, the first network **100** can remove the locked device **202** from the network blacklist **228**. Accordingly, the first network **100** can allow the user to remedy any issues and re-register instead of permanently blacklisting the device. Thus, the first network **100** can allow the mobile device **102** to register and access the core network **106** in response to receiving a second/subsequent registration request after the predetermined duration according to the method **300**, so long as the request follows an update to the unlocked status **134** of the mobile device **102**.

(58) Computer

(59) FIG. **4** is a diagrammatic representation of a machine in the example form of a computer system **400** within which a set of instructions, for causing the machine to perform any one or more of the methodologies or modules discussed herein, can be executed.

(60) In the example of FIG. **4**, the computer system **400** includes a processor **402**, a memory **406**, a drive unit **420** (e.g., a machine-readable storage medium, such as a non-volatile memory), and an interface device **410**. Various common components (e.g., cache memory) are omitted for illustrative simplicity. The computer system **400** is intended to illustrate a hardware device on which any of the components described in the example of FIGS. **1-4** (and any other components described in this specification) can be implemented. The computer system **400** can be of any applicable known or convenient type. The components of the computer system **400** can be coupled together via a bus or through some other known or convenient device.

(61) This disclosure contemplates the computer system **400** taking any suitable physical form. As example and not by way of limitation, computer system **400** can be an embedded computer system, a system-on-chip (SOC), a single-board computer system (SBC) (such as, for example, a computer-on-module (COM) or system-on-module (SOM)), a desktop computer system, a laptop or notebook computer system, an interactive kiosk, a mainframe, a mesh of computer systems, a mobile telephone, a personal digital assistant (PDA), a server, or a combination of two or more of these. Where appropriate, computer system **400** can include one or more computer systems **400**; be unitary or distributed; span multiple locations; span multiple machines; or reside in a cloud, which can include one or more cloud components in one or more networks. Where appropriate, one or more computer systems **400** can perform without substantial spatial or temporal limitation one or more steps of one or more methods described or illustrated herein. As an example and not by way of limitation, one or more computer systems **400** can perform in real-time or in batch mode one or more steps of one or more methods described or illustrated herein. One or more computer systems **400** can perform at different times or at different locations one or more steps of one or more methods described or illustrated herein, where appropriate.

(62) The processor **402** can be, for example, a conventional microprocessor such as an Intel Pentium microprocessor or Motorola power PC microprocessor. One of skill in the relevant art will recognize that the terms “machine-readable (storage) medium” or “computer-readable (storage) medium” include any type of device that is accessible by the processor **402**.

(63) The memory **406** is coupled to the processor by, for example, a bus **424**. The memory **406** can include, by way of example but not limitation, random access memory (RAM), such as dynamic

RAM (DRAM) and static RAM (SRAM). The memory **406** can be local, remote, or distributed.

(64) The bus **424** also couples the processor **402** to the drive unit **420**. The drive unit **420** can include a non-volatile memory that is often a magnetic floppy or hard disk, a magnetic-optical disk, an optical disc, a read-only memory (ROM), such as a CD-ROM, EPROM, or EEPROM, a magnetic or optical card, or another form of storage for large amounts of data. Some of this data is often written, by a direct memory access process, into memory during execution of software in the computer **400**. The non-volatile storage can be local, remote, or distributed. The non-volatile memory is optional because systems can be created with all applicable data available in memory. A typical computer system will usually include at least a processor, memory, and a device (e.g., a bus) coupling the memory to the processor.

(65) Software is typically stored in the drive unit **420**. It should be understood that for software to run, if necessary, it is moved to a computer readable location appropriate for processing, and for illustrative purposes, that location is referred to as the memory in this paper. Even when software is moved to the memory for execution, the processor will typically make use of hardware registers to store values associated with the software, and local cache that, ideally, serves to speed up execution. As used herein, a software program is assumed to be stored at any known or convenient location (from non-volatile storage to hardware registers) when the software program is referred to as “implemented in a computer-readable medium.” A processor is considered to be “configured to execute a program” when at least one value associated with the program is stored in a register readable by the processor.

(66) The bus **424** also couples the processor **402** to the network interface device **410**. The network interface device **410** can include one or more of a modem or network interface. It will be appreciated that a modem or network interface can be considered to be part of the computer system **400**. The network interface device **410** can include an analog modem, ISDN modem, cable modem, token ring interface, satellite transmission interface (e.g., “direct PC”), or other interfaces for coupling a computer system to other computer systems.

(67) The system **400** can include one or more input and/or output devices, such as a video display **414** and/or an alpha-numeric input device **416**. The I/O devices can include, by way of example but not limitation, a keyboard, a mouse or other pointing device, disk drives, printers, a scanner, and other input and/or output devices, including a display device. The video display **414** can include, by way of example but not limitation, a cathode ray tube (CRT), liquid crystal display (LCD), or some other applicable known or convenient display device. For simplicity, it is assumed that controllers of any devices not depicted in the example of FIG. 4 reside in the interface.

(68) In operation, the computer system **400** can be controlled by operating system software that includes a file management system, such as a disk operating system. One example of operating system software with associated file management system software is the family of operating systems known as Windows® from Microsoft Corporation of Redmond, Washington, and their associated file management systems. Another example of operating system software with its associated file management system software is the Linux™ operating system and its associated file management system. The file management system is typically stored in the non-volatile memory and/or drive unit and causes the processor to execute the various acts required by the operating system to input and output data and to store data in the memory, including storing files on the non-volatile memory and/or drive unit.

(69) Some portions of the detailed description can be presented in terms of algorithms and symbolic representations of operations on data bits within a computer memory. These algorithmic descriptions and representations are the means used by those skilled in the data processing arts to most effectively convey the substance of their work to others skilled in the art. An algorithm is here, and generally, conceived to be a self-consistent sequence of operations leading to a desired result. The operations are those requiring physical manipulations of physical quantities. Usually, though not necessarily, these quantities take the form of electrical or magnetic signals capable of

being stored, transferred, combined, compared, and otherwise manipulated. It has proven convenient at times, principally for reasons of common usage, to refer to these signals as bits, values, elements, symbols, characters, terms, numbers, or the like.

(70) It should be borne in mind, however, that all of these and similar terms are to be associated with the appropriate physical quantities and are merely convenient labels applied to these quantities. Unless specifically stated otherwise as apparent from the following discussion, it is appreciated that throughout the description, discussions utilizing terms such as “processing” or “computing” or “calculating” or “determining” or “displaying” or “generating” or the like, refer to the action and processes of a computer system, or similar electronic computing device, that manipulates and transforms data represented as physical (electronic) quantities within the computer system's registers and memories into other data similarly represented as physical quantities within the computer system memories or registers or other such information storage, transmission or display devices.

(71) The algorithms and displays presented herein are not inherently related to any particular computer or other apparatus. Various general purpose systems can be used with programs in accordance with the teachings herein, or it can prove convenient to construct more specialized apparatus to perform the methods of some implementations. The required structure for a variety of these systems will appear from the description below. In addition, the techniques are not described with reference to any particular programming language, and various implementations can thus be implemented using a variety of programming languages.

(72) In alternative implementations, the machine operates as a standalone device or can be connected (e.g., networked) to other machines. In a networked deployment, the machine can operate in the capacity of a server or a client machine in a client-server network environment, or as a peer machine in a peer-to-peer (or distributed) network environment.

(73) The machine can be a server computer, a client computer, a personal computer (PC), a tablet PC, a laptop computer, a set-top box (STB), a personal digital assistant (PDA), a cellular telephone, an iPhone, a Blackberry, a processor, a telephone, a web appliance, a network router, switch or bridge, or any machine capable of executing a set of instructions (sequential or otherwise) that specify actions to be taken by that machine.

(74) While the machine-readable medium or machine-readable storage medium is shown in an exemplary implementation to be a single medium, the term “machine-readable medium” and “machine-readable storage medium” should be taken to include a single medium or multiple media (e.g., a centralized or distributed database, and/or associated caches and servers) that store the one or more sets of instructions. The term “machine-readable medium” and “machine-readable storage medium” shall also be taken to include any medium that is capable of storing, encoding, or carrying a set of instructions for execution by the machine and that cause the machine to perform any one or more of the methodologies or modules of the presently disclosed technique and innovation.

(75) In general, the routines executed to implement the embodiments of the disclosure, can be implemented as part of an operating system or a specific application, component, program, object, module, or sequence of instructions referred to as “computer programs.” The computer programs typically comprise one or more instructions set at various times in various memory and storage devices in a computer, and that, when read and executed by one or more processing units or processors in a computer, cause the computer to perform operations to execute elements involving the various aspects of the disclosure.

(76) Moreover, while implementations have been described in the context of fully functioning computers and computer systems, those skilled in the art will appreciate that the various implementations are capable of being distributed as a program product in a variety of forms, and that the disclosure applies equally regardless of the particular type of machine or computer-readable media used to actually effect the distribution.

(77) Further examples of machine-readable storage media, machine-readable media, or computer-

readable (storage) media include but are not limited to recordable type media such as volatile and non-volatile memory devices, floppy and other removable disks, hard disk drives, optical discs (e.g., Compact Disc Read-Only Memory (CD ROMS), Digital Versatile Discs, (DVDs), etc.), among others, and transmission type media such as digital and analog communication links.

(78) In some circumstances, operation of a memory device, such as a change in state from a binary one to a binary zero or vice-versa, for example, can comprise a transformation, such as a physical transformation. With particular types of memory devices, such a physical transformation can comprise a physical transformation of an article to a different state or thing. For example, but without limitation, for some types of memory devices, a change in state can involve an accumulation and storage of charge or a release of stored charge. Likewise, in other memory devices, a change of state can comprise a physical change or transformation in magnetic orientation or a physical change or transformation in molecular structure, such as from crystalline to amorphous or vice versa. The foregoing is not intended to be an exhaustive list in which a change in state for a binary one to a binary zero or vice-versa in a memory device can comprise a transformation, such as a physical transformation. Rather, the foregoing is intended as illustrative examples.

(79) A storage medium typically can be non-transitory or comprise a non-transitory device. In this context, a non-transitory storage medium can include a device that is tangible, meaning that the device has a concrete physical form, although the device can change its physical state. Thus, for example, non-transitory refers to a device remaining tangible despite this change in state.

(80) Remarks

(81) Unless the context clearly requires otherwise, throughout the description and the claims, the words “comprise,” “comprising,” and the like are to be construed in an inclusive sense, as opposed to an exclusive or exhaustive sense; that is to say, in the sense of “including, but not limited to.” As used herein, the terms “connected,” “coupled,” or any variant thereof means any connection or coupling, either direct or indirect, between two or more elements; the coupling or connection between the elements can be physical, logical, or a combination thereof. Additionally, the words “herein,” “above,” “below,” and words of similar import, when used in this application, refer to this application as a whole and not to any particular portions of this application. Where the context permits, words in the above Detailed Description using the singular or plural number may also include the plural or singular number respectively. The word “or” in reference to a list of two or more items covers all of the following interpretations of the word: any of the items in the list, all of the items in the list, and any combination of the items in the list.

(82) The above Detailed Description of examples of the invention is not intended to be exhaustive or to limit the invention to the precise form disclosed above. While specific examples for the invention are described above for illustrative purposes, various equivalent modifications are possible within the scope of the invention, as those skilled in the relevant art will recognize. For example, while processes or blocks are presented in a given order, alternative implementations may perform routines having steps, or employ systems having blocks, in a different order, and some processes or blocks may be deleted, moved, added, subdivided, combined, and/or modified to provide alternative or sub-combinations. Each of these processes or blocks may be implemented in a variety of different ways. Also, while processes or blocks are at times shown as being performed in series, these processes or blocks may instead be performed or implemented in parallel, or may be performed at different times. Further, any specific numbers noted herein are only examples; alternative implementations may employ differing values or ranges.

(83) The teachings of the invention provided herein can be applied to other systems, not necessarily the system described above. The elements and acts of the various examples described above can be combined to provide further implementations of the invention. Some alternative implementations of the invention may include not only additional elements to those implementations noted above, but also may include fewer elements.

(84) Any patents and applications and other references noted above, and any that may be listed in accompanying filing papers, are incorporated herein by reference in the entirety, except for any subject matter disclaimers or disavowals, and except to the extent that the incorporated material is inconsistent with the express disclosure herein, in which case the language in this disclosure controls. Aspects of the invention can be modified to employ the systems, functions, and concepts of the various references described above to provide yet further implementations of the invention.

(85) These and other changes can be made to the invention in light of the above Detailed Description. While the above description describes certain examples of the invention, and describes the best mode contemplated, no matter how detailed the above appears in text, the invention can be practiced in many ways. Details of the system may vary considerably in its specific implementation, while still being encompassed by the invention disclosed herein. As noted above, particular terminology used when describing certain features or aspects of the invention should not be taken to imply that the terminology is being redefined herein to be restricted to any specific characteristics, features, or aspects of the invention with which that terminology is associated. In general, the terms used in the following claims should not be construed to limit the invention to the specific examples disclosed in the specification, unless the above Detailed Description section explicitly defines such terms. Accordingly, the actual scope of the invention encompasses not only the disclosed examples, but also all equivalent ways of practicing or implementing the invention under the claims.

(86) To reduce the number of claims, certain aspects of the invention are presented below in certain claim forms, but the applicant contemplates the various aspects of the invention in any number of claim forms. For example, while only one aspect of the invention is recited as a means-plus-function claim under 35 U.S.C. § 112(f), other aspects may likewise be embodied as a means-plus-function claim, or in other forms, such as being embodied in a computer-readable medium. (Any claims intended to be treated under 35 U.S.C. § 112(f) will begin with the words “means for,” but use of the term “for” in any other context is not intended to invoke treatment under 35 U.S.C. § 112(f).) Accordingly, the applicant reserves the right to pursue additional claims after filing this application to pursue such additional claim forms, in either this application or in a continuing application.

Claims

1. An apparatus for communicating with networks of first and second types, the apparatus comprising: one or more processors; and at least one memory coupled to the one or more processors, wherein the memory stores an identifier and includes instructions executable by the one or more processors to: provide a registration request to the network of the first type, wherein the provided registration request includes the identifier; wherein, in response to receipt of the registration request, the network of the first type: receives an authorization status for the apparatus on the network of the second type, wherein the authorization status includes a locked status representing permission for the apparatus to register outside of the network of the second type; and in response to an absence of permission from the locked status, adds the identifier for the apparatus to a set of identifiers for preventing the apparatus from accessing another network outside of the network of the second type.

2. The apparatus of claim 1: wherein the at least one memory includes a transportable access module for storing the identifier and a nonvolatile memory for storing the instructions; wherein the received registration request is a first received request; wherein the apparatus provides a second registration request and a status update for the apparatus, and wherein the identifier is compatible with the network of the first type; and wherein the network of the second type registers the apparatus to access the network of the first type based on the second registration request after denying the first registration request.

3. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein: the identifier includes (1) a non-transferable identifier that directly represents the apparatus specifically for the network of the second type and (2) a device-transferrable identifier for the network of the first type; and identification that the registration request is from the apparatus initially configured to operate on the network of the second type when (1) the non-transferable identifier is absent from subscriber information of the network of the first type and (2) the device-transferrable identifier is found within the subscriber information.
4. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein: the network of the first type is a Global System for Mobile Communications (GSM) network; and the registration request represents a request from the apparatus initially configured to operate on a Code-Division Multiple Access (CDMA) type network.
5. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the memory includes further instructions executable by the one or more processors to: receive a message based on the identifier, wherein the message is for communicating to a user of apparatus regarding temporary denial of access to the network of the first type.
6. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the network of the second type comprises a cross-registration database is for identifying unlocked devices authorized to connect to networks outside of an initially-contracted network for the apparatus.
7. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the instructions further comprise executing network registration so as to register the apparatus to access the network of the first type when the authorization status indicates the apparatus as an unlocked device.
8. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the network of the first type: identifies that the apparatus is initially configured to operate on the network of the second type, wherein the network of the second type is communicatively coupled to, but operationally differs from, the network of first type; and sends a cross-registration query including the identifier for the apparatus to the network of the second type.
9. At least one non-transitory, computer-readable medium, carrying instructions, which when executed by an apparatus for communicating with networks of first and second types, performs operations, the operations comprising: provide a registration request to the network of the first type, wherein the registration provided request includes an identifier for the apparatus; wherein, in response to receipt of the registration request, the network of the first type: receives an authorization status for the apparatus on the network of the second type, wherein the authorization status includes a locked status representing permission for the apparatus to register outside of the network of the second type; and in response to an absence of permission from the locked status, adds the identifier for the apparatus to a set of identifiers for preventing the apparatus from accessing at least the network of the first type.
10. The at least one non-transitory, computer-readable medium of claim 9: wherein the received registration request is a first received request; wherein the apparatus provides a second registration request and a status update for the apparatus, and wherein the identifier is compatible with the network of the first type; and wherein the network of the first type registers the apparatus to access the network of the first type based on the second registration request after denying the first registration request.
11. The at least one non-transitory, computer-readable medium of claim 9, wherein: the identifier includes (1) a non-transferable identifier that directly represents the apparatus specifically for the network of the second type and (2) a device-transferrable identifier for the network of the first type; and identification that the registration request is from the apparatus initially configured to operate on the network of the second type when (1) the non-transferable identifier is absent from subscriber information of the network of the first type, and (2) the device-transferrable identifier is found within the subscriber information.
12. The at least one non-transitory, computer-readable medium of claim 9, wherein: the network of the first type is a Global System for Mobile Communications (GSM) network; and the registration

request represents a request from the apparatus initially configured to operate on a Code-Division Multiple Access (CDMA) type network.

13. The at least one non-transitory, computer-readable medium of claim 9, wherein the instructions further include: receiving a message based on the identifier, wherein the message is for communicating to a user of the apparatus regarding temporary denial of access to the network of the first type.

14. The at least one non-transitory, computer-readable medium of claim 9, wherein the network of the second type comprises a database is for identifying unlocked devices authorized to connect to networks outside of an initially-contracted network for the apparatus.

15. The at least one non-transitory, computer-readable medium of claim 9, wherein the instructions further comprise executing network registration so as to register the apparatus to access the network of the first type when the authorization status indicates the apparatus as an unlocked device.

16. The at least one non-transitory, computer-readable medium of claim 9, wherein the network of the first type: identifies that the apparatus is initially configured to operate on the network of the second type, wherein the network of the second type is communicatively coupled to, but operationally differs from, the network of first type; and sends a cross-registration query including the identifier for the apparatus to the network of the second type.

17. A method for use in a wireless telecommunications network, the method comprising: managing registration of user equipment devices, configured on a first type of network, for a second, different type of network; querying the first type of network for authorization status of the user equipment devices configured on the first type of network; for each user equipment device configured on the first type of network, either: a) registering the user equipment device configured on the first type of network, and providing network access to the user equipment device configured on the first type of network, when the authorization status indicates eligibility, or b) temporarily adding the user equipment device configured on the first type of network to a set of user equipment devices prevented from registering on the second type of network, wherein when a temporary status expires, the user equipment device configured on the first type of network is permitted to re-register.

18. The method of claim 17, wherein: the first type of network is a CDMA network, and the second type of network is a GSM network.

19. The method of claim 17, wherein: wherein the authorization status represents that a particular user equipment device has met requirements for unlocking the particular user equipment device.

20. The method of claim 17, wherein: wherein the temporary status expires after a predetermined duration to enable the user equipment device configured on the first type of network to re-register at using a proper SIM.
